

Judah Van Zandt, Ph.D.

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Astronomy & Astrophysics , University of California, Los Angeles	April 2025
M.S. in Astronomy & Astrophysics , University of California, Los Angeles	November 2021
B.S. in Physics and Mathematics , University of Notre Dame	May 2019

APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of California, Santa Barbara	2025 – present
Graduate Student Researcher, University of California, Los Angeles	2019 – 2025
Summer Undergraduate Research Fellow (SURF), Caltech	2018
Undergraduate Researcher, University of Notre Dame	2016 – 2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Exoplanet demographics and system architectures; Doppler spectroscopy; planet detection and characterization.

OBSERVING EXPERIENCE

Keck/KPF, 10 nights	2024 – present
Keck/HIRES, 70+ nights	2019 – 2024
Keck/NIRC2, 1 night	2023
Lick/Shane, 10 nights	2025 – present

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Future Investigators in NASA Earth and Space Science and Technology (FINESST; \$150,000)	2022 – 2024
Keck, “The <i>TESS</i> -Keck Distant Giants Survey: Probing the Prevalence of Solar System-like Architectures,” 10 nights	2022 – 2023

TEACHING & MENTORING

Students Advised

Maleah Rhem, University of Kansas graduate student	2025 – present
Yena Kim, Los Angeles High School student	2024 – 2025
Benji Karben, Los Angeles High School student	2023 – 2024
Daniel Valle, UCLA undergraduate	2021

Teaching Assistant, University of California, Los Angeles

Planets and Exoplanets	Winter 2024, 2025
Newtonian Mechanics Laboratory	Fall 2020
Radiation and Fluids in Astrophysics	Spring 2020
Applications of Thermodynamics to Astrophysics	Winter 2020

Teaching Mentor (remote), GEC Academy, Beijing

Exoplanets and Orbital Dynamics	Summer 2022, 2023
Hot Topics in Astronomy	Summer 2022
Galaxy and Structure Formation	Summer 2020
Quantum Mechanics and Quantum Computing	Summer 2020

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

1. **Judah Van Zandt** and 20 colleagues. The γ Cephei System: Updated Orbits, Dynamical Architecture, and Limits on Additional Companions. *AJ*, *accepted*; *arXiv:2608.30030*, August 2026
2. **Judah Van Zandt** and 14 colleagues. Gaia Exoplanet Orbits, Demographics, and Evolution Survey (GEODES). I. Characteristics of Three Long-period Companions Accelerating their Host Stars. *ApJ*, 1006(2):222, August 2026
3. **Judah Van Zandt** and 5 colleagues. A Smooth Transition from Giant Planets to Brown Dwarfs from the Radial Occurrence Distribution. *AJ*, 171(5):267, May 2026
4. Gregory J. Gilbert, **Judah Van Zandt**, and 4 colleagues. Orbital Eccentricities Suggest a Gradual Transition from Giant Planets to Brown Dwarfs. *AJ*, 171(2):67, February 2026
5. **Judah Van Zandt** and 37 colleagues. The TESS–Keck Survey. XXIV. Outer Giants May Be More Prevalent in the Presence of Inner Small Planets. *AJ*, 169(5):235, May 2025
6. **Judah Van Zandt** and Erik A. Petigura. No Evidence for a Metallicity-dependent Enhancement of Distant Giant Companions to Close-in Small Planets in the California Legacy Survey. *AJ*, 168(6):268, December 2024
7. **Judah Van Zandt** and Erik A. Petigura. ethraid: A Simple Method for Characterizing Long-period Companions Using Doppler, Astrometric, and Imaging Constraints. *AJ*, 167(6):250, June 2024
8. **Judah Van Zandt** and 44 colleagues. TESS–Keck Survey. XIV. Two Giant Exoplanets from the Distant Giants Survey. *AJ*, 165(2):60, February 2023
9. Jack Lubin, **Judah Van Zandt**, and 34 colleagues. TESS–Keck Survey. IX. Masses of Three Sub-Neptunes Orbiting HD 191939 and the Discovery of a Warm Jovian plus a Distant Substellar Companion. *AJ*, 163(2):101, February 2022

INVITED TALKS

On the Shoulders of Giants, Torino, Italy	March 2026
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CONTRIBUTED TALKS

Keck Science Meeting, Caltech	September 2026
Preparing for the Gaia Exoplanet Bonanza, Ringberg, Germany	March 2026
51 Pegasi b 30th Anniversary Conference	October 2025
American Astronomical Society Meeting	January 2024, 2025
Exoplanet Researchers in Southern California	December 2024
Exoplanet Researchers in Southern California	December 2023
Emerging Researchers in Exoplanet Science VII	August 2022
American Astronomical Society Meeting 240	June 2022
NASA Exoplanet Exploration Program Analysis Group	June 2022
Keck Science Meeting, UC San Diego	September 2021